OPEN AGENT HACKATHON 2026 · TRACK 02 · THE AGENT THAT CAN EXPLAIN WHY

Lintel

Know the building
before you sign.

An agent that answers a renter's question about one New York building from city records, and shows exactly why.



lintel-why.vercel.app

THE PROBLEM

The city already knows if the heat works. The renter finds out in January.

WHO

New York renters, in the days before they sign a lease.

WHY IT HURTS

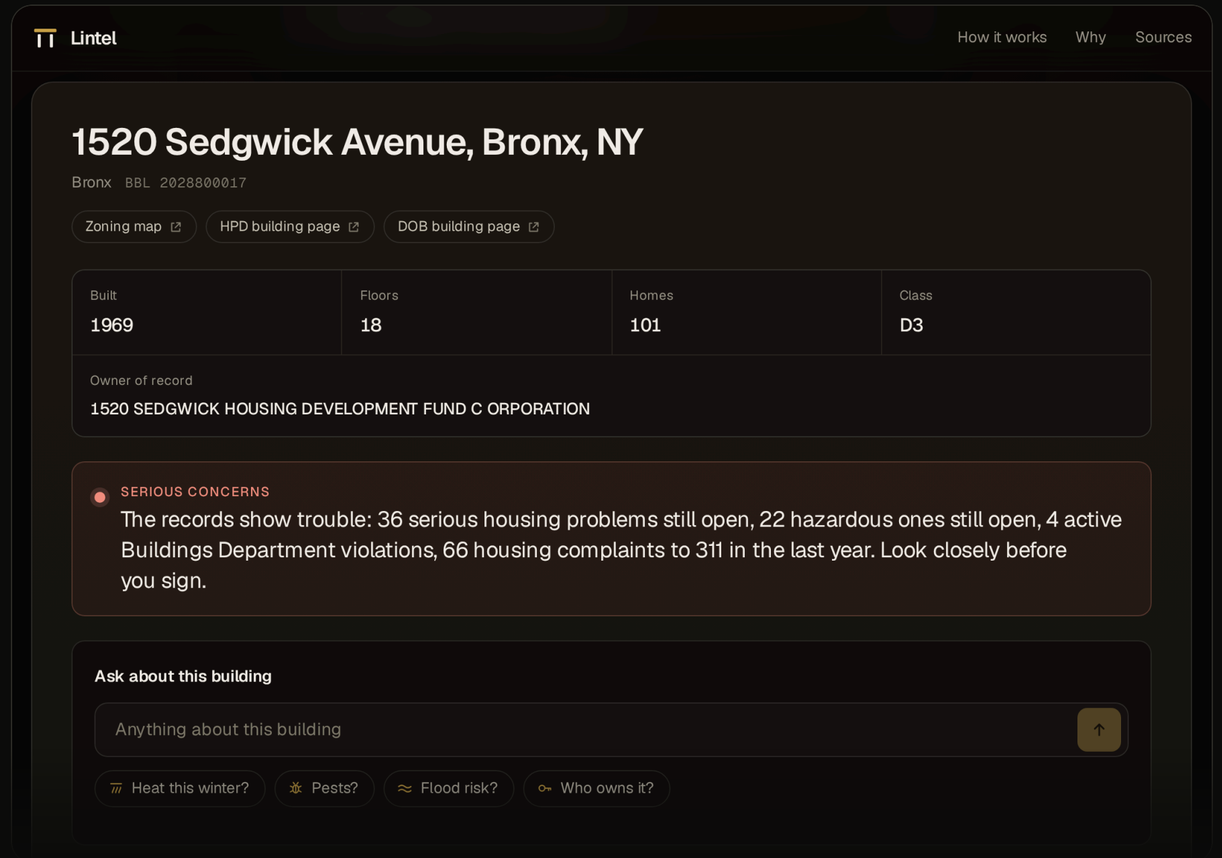
Violations, 311 calls, owners and flood maps are public, but spread over datasets nobody reads.

EXAMPLE

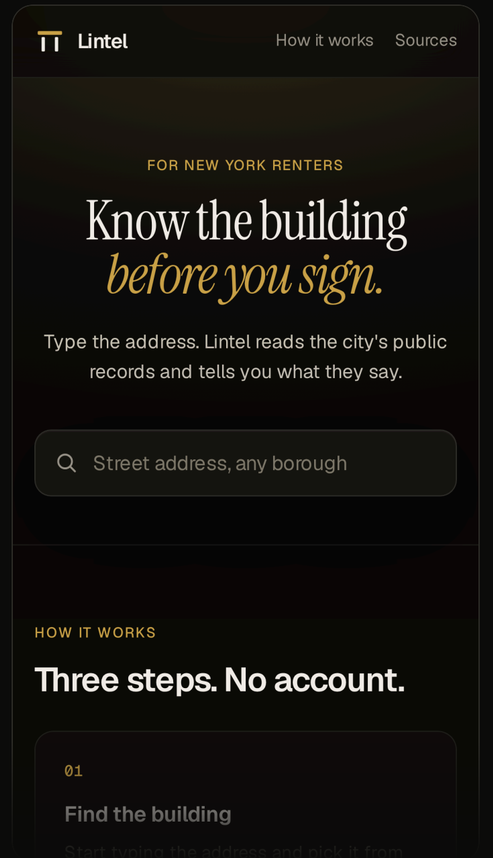
1520 Sedgwick Avenue, Bronx: 36 serious and 22 hazardous housing problems open. None of it is on the listing.

THE SOLUTION

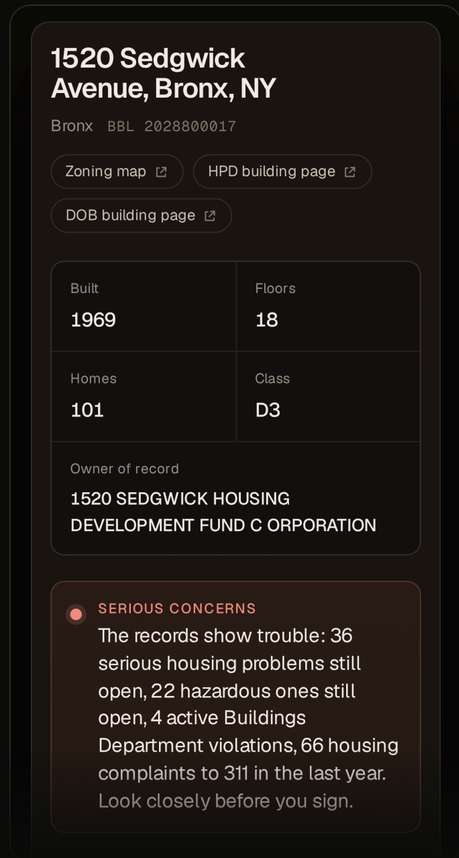
Type the address. Read the verdict. Ask anything.



Building card, desktop



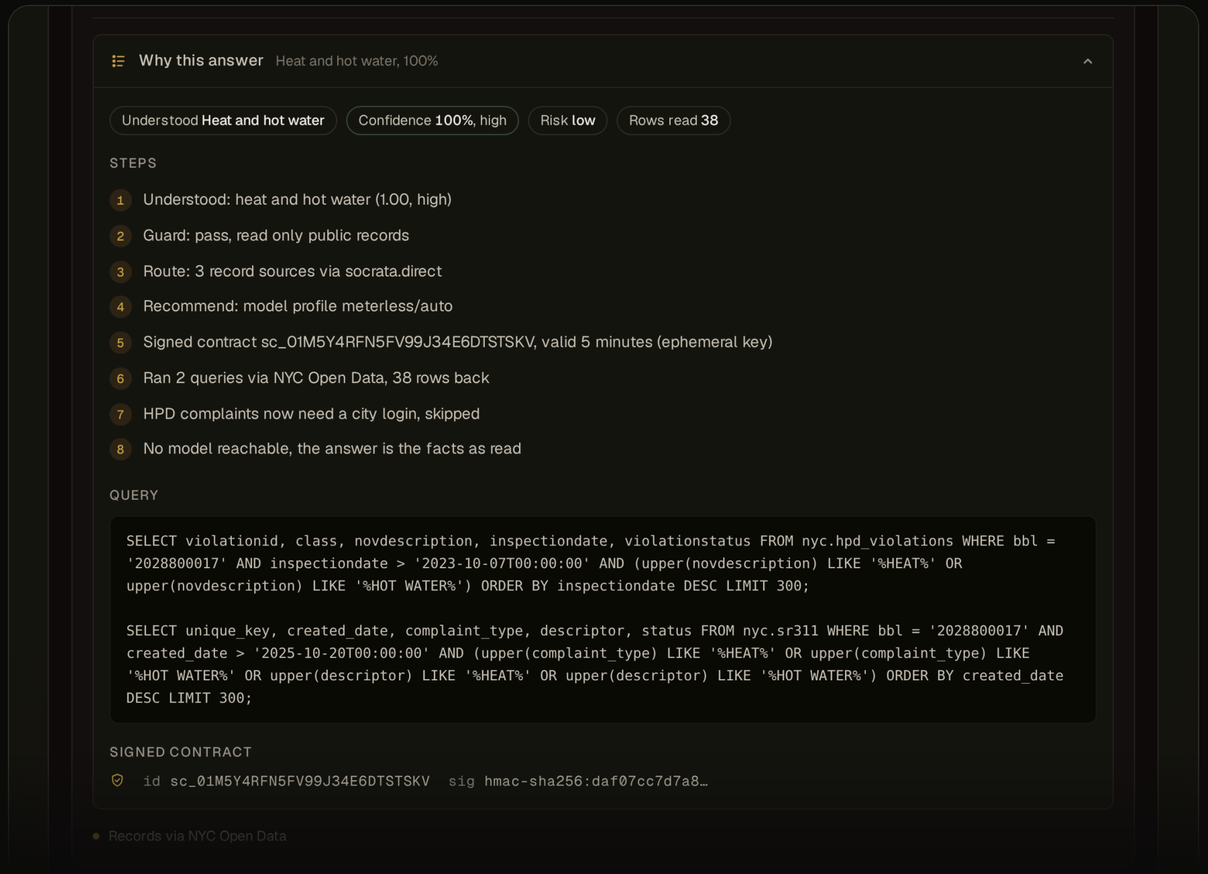
Mobile: search



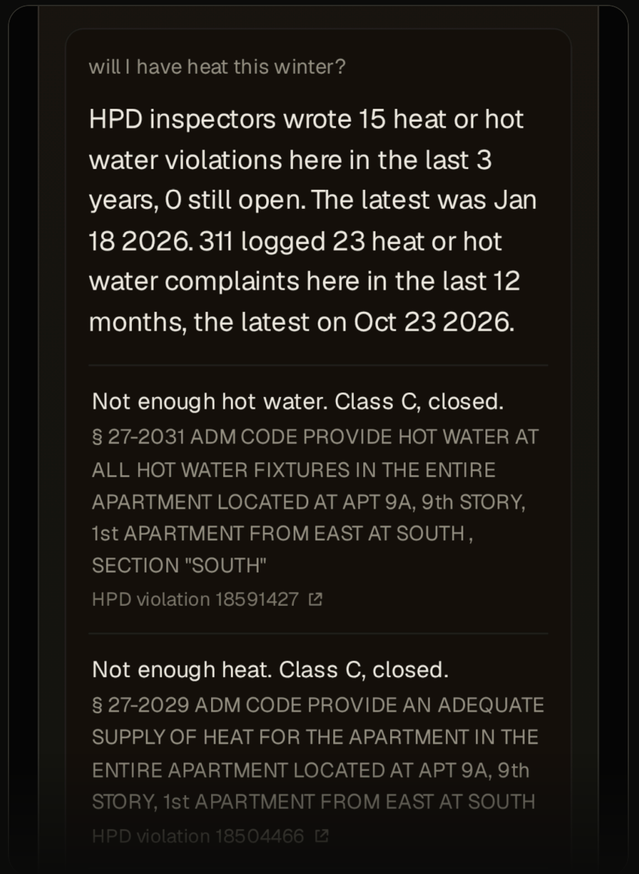
Mobile: verdict

PRODUCT

Every answer opens up to show why.



Why this answer: intent, steps, the SQL that ran, signed contract



The answer, records linked

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

Nothing runs until the question has a signed contract.

ASK

Renter question

Bound to one building, resolved by NYC GeoSearch.

→

METERLESS

Scout Intent

Sense, Interpret, Guard, Route, Recommend.

→

CONTRACT

HMAC signed

Lists the only tools allowed to run.

→

ZETARIS

SQL tools

One SQL statement per tool over NYC records.

→

WRITER

Nightshift or rules

Writes only from the rows that came back.

→

OUT

Answer

With evidence links, steps, SQL and contract id.

`Injection or off topic:` refused, nothing runs

`Vague question:` one clarifying choice instead of a guess

HOW WE USE METERLESS

Scout Intent gates every question.

Sense › Interpret › Guard › Route › Recommend

1.000	0.966	0.900	0.063
injection recall	tool precision	blind top-1 intent	clarification rate

Nightshift writes the answer when connected. Otherwise deterministic rules do, and the answer names which one ran.

HOW WE USE ZETARIS

One SQL layer over the city's records.

```
/* zetaris/register.sql */
CREATE LIGHTNING REST TABLE hpd_violations
  FROM NYC REQUEST(endpoint ".../wvxf-dwi5.json")

/* what the heat tool runs */
SELECT violationid, class, novdescription
FROM nyc.hpd_violations
WHERE bbl = '2028800017'
  AND upper(novdescription) LIKE '%HEAT%'
```

- NYC datasets registered as Zetaris sources
  app/zetaris.py sends every tool query through it
- The query you see is the query that ran
  shown in the Why panel, with rows read
- Zetaris ready. The live demo runs the same SQL direct on NYC Open Data
  labeled "direct", since no Zetaris instance is connected there

WHAT IS UNIQUE

Intent is a permission, not a label.

CONTRACT BEFORE TOOLS

Scout Intent does not just classify. Its signed contract is the allow list the agent executes against.

SQL AS THE EXPLANATION

The why is not a story written afterwards. It is the exact query and rows behind each claim.

HONEST PROVENANCE

Every answer says which data path and which writer ran: Zetaris or direct, Nightshift or rules.

TECH STACK AND DATA

Small stack. Public records only.

- Python 3.12, FastAPI
  on Vercel Python functions
- Plain HTML, CSS and JS
  no build step, works on a phone
- Meterless Scout Intent and Nightshift
  intent gate and model provider
- Zetaris
  SQL data layer

HPD housing violations	`wvxf-dwi5`
311 service requests	`erm2-nwe9`
DOB violations	`3h2n-5cm9`
PLUTO lot record	`64uk-42ks`
Floodplain 2050s	`27ya-gqtm`
Addresses	`NYC GeoSearch`
Commute times	`Transitous`

ROADMAP

Next: more of the city, joined in one place.

01

Live Zetaris instance with joins across datasets

02

Owner portfolio: every building the landlord holds

03

Compare two buildings side by side

04

Alerts when new violations land before move in

Try it at lintel-why.vercel.app

Type 1520 Sedgwick Avenue, Bronx. Ask: will I have heat this winter?